

DATA COLLECTION INSTRUMENTS: The Bare Female Market Research

■ **Methodological Note:** The original research proposal included pinned/featured comments as a third unit of critique for the qualitative content analysis. Upon conducting fieldwork, it was determined that The Bare Female does not use the pinned comment feature. The sample was therefore redistributed across video descriptions and community posts.

A. Qualitative Content Analysis Coding Schema		
Units of Analysis: Individual video descriptions & community posts. ::::: Coding Scale: 0 = Absent 1 = Present 2 = Prominent		
Category	Operational Definition	Examples
Community Language	Use of inclusive pronouns, group identity terms, belonging cues	“Help support you,” “loving community,” “connective sisterhood”
Inner Authority References	Messaging that locates wisdom, healing, and guidance within the self	Self-trust cues, embodiment references, and return/homecoming metaphors
Engagement Prompts	Direct calls to interact, comment, share or respond	“Journey invites you,” “Dive into your body,” “help you navigate”
Values Alignment	Messaging that signals shared beliefs or lifestyle identity	References to transformation, mindful living, authentic expression, soulful
Exclusivity	Content framing membership as special or privileged	“Exclusive bundles,” “Retreats for women,” “sacred online membership”

B. Quantitative Audience Response Coding Rubric		
Unit of Analysis: YouTube Comments Dimensions 1 - 5: 0 = Absent 1 = Present 2 = Prominent Sentiment: 1 = Negative 2 = Neutral 3 = Positive		
Dimension	Indicators	Score Descriptions
Sense of Belonging	Describes feeling part of community, group, shared space, including language related to being held, witnessed, not alone.	0 = No belonging language 1 = Positive group feeling (“I love this community!”) 2 = Deep relational language (“I finally found my people”)
Parasocial Intimacy with Instructor	Addresses or describes the instructor with relational, emotional, or friendship-oriented language.	0 = No personal reference 1 = Warm but general (“she’s great,” “I love her energy”) 2 = Intimate framing (“she feels like a friend,” “your presence means everything”)
Inner Authority Mirroring	Echoes the brand’s self-trust / inner wisdom rhetoric, describing changes in self-perception, body trust, or self-acceptance.	0 = Absent 1 = Self-improvement language (“I feel better about myself”) 2 = Explicit usage of brand rhetoric (“I’m learning to trust myself,” “Coming home to my body”)
Emotional & Somatic Transformation	Describes personal growth, emotional shift, embodiment or life change, pertaining to body acceptance, cyclical living or healing.	0 = Absent 1 = Vague or brief mention (“it changed me”) 2 = Specific, embodied account (“I removed my IUD and began honoring my monthly cycle”)
Loyalty & Sustained Engagement	Mentions continued use, long membership, returning after absence, or makes strong recommendations.	0 = Absent 1 = Implied continued use or positive recommendation 2 = Explicit loyalty statement, duration mentioned, active evangelism
Overall Sentiment	General emotional tone of comment or review.	1 = Negative / critical 2 = Neutral / mixed 3 = Positive / enthusiastic